TOPIC 18: THE DECCAN & THE MUGHALS (TO 1657)

POST-BAHMANI FIELD
Ahmadnagar + Bijapur + Golconda + Khandesh gateway
-> Deccan connected by routes, trade, service elites and forts
-> yet frictional because monsoon, fodder, distance and local power mattered

AKBAR'S OPENING
Khandesh/Burhanpur/Asirgarh -> gateway secured
1591 missions -> demand for Mughal over-lordship
Khandesh submits; major Deccan courts do not

AHMADNAGAR CRISIS
1595-96 succession struggle
-> Chand Bibi backs infant Bahadur
-> four-month defence
-> Berar ceded under Mughal suzerainty

FOOTHOLD, NOT FINISH
1597 Berar recovery attempt fails
1600 Ahmadnagar fort falls
1601 Asirgarh/Khandesh secured
-> but Nizam Shahi remnant survives
-> conquest on paper still needs countryside control

MALIK AMBAR
Habshi origin -> Nizam Shahi Peshwa
-> claimant legitimacy + coalition + Maratha bargis
-> mobility + intelligence + supply-cutting
-> later evidence of zabti-type reconstruction + Khirki support

WHY CONSOLIDATION FAILED
artillery and forts mattered
but revenue, hasil, fodder, routes and local cooperation mattered too
-> fort victory != durable rule

JAHANGIR PHASE
1610 reversal outside secure bases
1611 failed Mughal coordination
1616-17 / 1621 recoveries under Khan-i-Khanan and Khurram
1624 Bhaturi
-> recovery with restraint, not final annexation

MARATHA SERVICE BRIDGE
deshmukhs + bargis + shifting service ties + Shahji
-> prehistory of later Maratha power
-> not yet the mature Shivaji state

SHAH JAHAN AND AHMADNAGAR
Khan-i-Jahan Lodi asylum sharpens policy
Fath Khan defects
1633 Daulatabad falls; ruling line ends
-> Shahji still sustains claimant resistance

1636 SETTLEMENT
Bijapur -> suzerainty + indemnity + arbitration + Shahji condition
Golconda -> khutba shift + tribute/protection
-> buffer courts survive
-> annexation avoided because cost mattered

1652-57 PRESSURE
Aurangzeb's second viceroyalty + Murshid Quli Khan
-> deficit, weak realization and search for relief
Mir Jumla breaks with Golconda (1656)
Bijapur succession crisis (1656-57)
-> Ramgir and former Nizam Shahi lands taken
-> spirit of 1636 broken

FINAL VERDICT
Topic ends at 1657:

Mughal power moved from embassy to foothold to coalition war to suzerainty settlement to renewed breach.
The unresolved problem was simple to state and hard to solve: how to convert victory into durable, affordable Deccan rule.